



Ariemmas

POINT OF SALE

Staff Training Guide

Everything cashiers and administrators need to run the till, sell by weight, take payment, and track every transaction — with pictures of every screen.

For Cashiers

For Administrators

Hardware Setup

Troubleshooting

Ariemmas Shop · Mongu, Zambia

Version 1.0 · Application v1.0.10

Ariemmas POS — Staff Training Guide

Part 1: For Cashiers

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How to read this guide

Steps you perform are **numbered**. Buttons and screen labels look like **"Open Shift"**. Keys on the keyboard look like **F12**. Every important screen has a picture so you can match what you see.

Welcome & the basics

Ariemmas POS is the till software the shop runs on its touchscreen terminals. It records every sale, prints receipts, opens the cash drawer, tracks stock, and shows the owner exactly how much was sold and by whom.

1.1 Who uses it

CASHIER

Runs the till

Signs in with a cashier login, opens a shift with their name, scans or searches products, weighs butchery items, takes cash or mobile money, and closes the shift at the end of the day.

ADMINISTRATOR

Runs the shop

Adds and prices products, prints barcodes, marks items as sold-by-weight, reads the daily reports (who sold what), exports to Excel, and configures the printer and drawer.

1.2 The three things every cashier does, every day

- 1 **Open a shift** when you start — type your name and the cash in the drawer.
- 2 **Ring up sales** all day — scan/search items, take payment, hand over the receipt.
- 3 **Close the shift** when you finish — count the drawer so the totals balance.

Works without internet

The till keeps working even if the internet goes down. Sales are saved on the terminal and sent to the owner's dashboard automatically when the connection returns.

1.3 A note on prices and VAT

The price on the shelf is the price the customer pays. **VAT is switched off by default**, because the business is new and not yet VAT-registered. With VAT off, receipts simply show the **Total** — there is no VAT line, and you never calculate anything by hand.

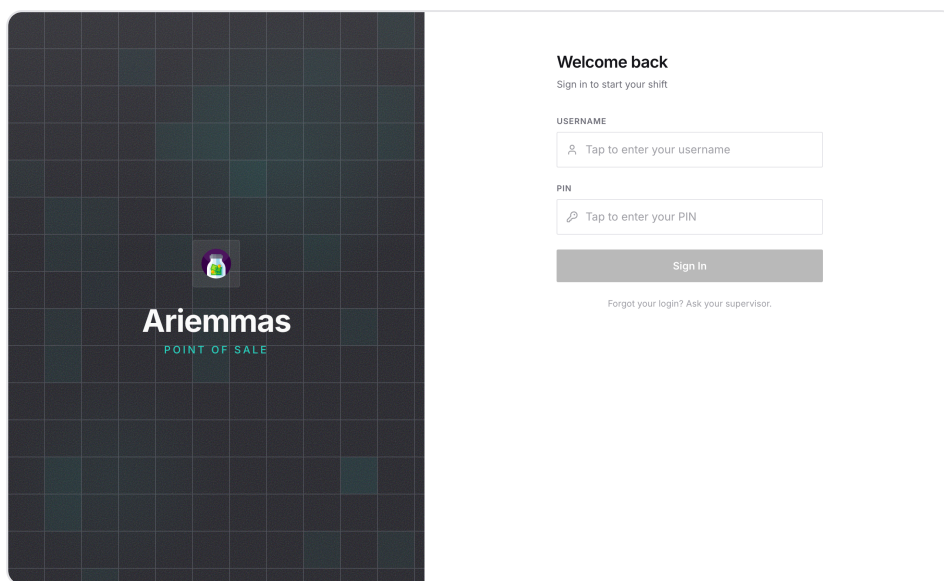
Once the business registers for VAT with ZRA, the owner turns it on with a single switch in **Settings → Charge VAT** (see section 3.6). From then on prices are treated as VAT-inclusive and the system shows the VAT portion on every receipt automatically. **Cashiers don't need to do anything different either way.**

Cashier Guide

This is everything you do on the till, from signing in to closing your shift. Follow it in order the first few times and it will quickly become second nature.

2.1 Signing in

When the terminal is ready you'll see the sign-in screen. Each person has their own username and PIN — your supervisor gives you yours. (Logins are no longer shown on screen, for security.)



The sign-in screen. Tap the Username and PIN boxes to type with the on-screen keyboard — no Windows keyboard needed.

- 1 Tap the **Username** box and type your username (for example *cashier1*) on the on-screen keyboard, then tap **“Done”**.
- 2 Tap the **PIN** box and type your PIN on the keypad.
- 3 Tap **“SIGN IN”**.

Welcome back
Sign in to start your shift

USERNAME
cashier1

PIN
••••

Sign In

Forgot your login? Ask your supervisor.

ENTER YOUR PIN Done

7	8	9	⬅
4	5	6	CLR
1	2	3	SIGN IN
0	.		

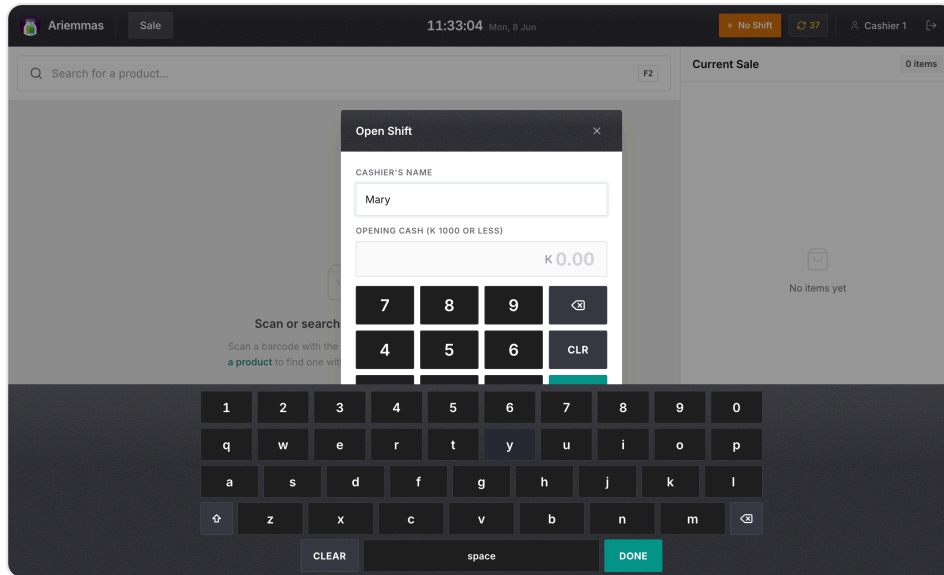
Type your username and PIN on the on-screen keyboard / keypad, then SIGN IN.

Use your own login

Always sign in as yourself. Every sale is tagged with your login, so the owner can see who served each customer. Signing in as someone else makes the reports wrong. Never share your PIN.

2.2 Opening your shift

Before you can sell anything you must open a shift. This records who is on the till and how much cash you started with.



The Open Shift window. It asks for your real name and the opening cash.

- 1 If you see **"No Shift"** at the top right, tap it to open this window.
- 2 Tap the **"Cashier's Name"** box. An **on-screen letters keyboard** slides up — type the name of the real person on the till today, for example *Mary Banda*, then tap **"Done"**. (The login may be "Cashier 1", but the owner wants the real name.)
- 3 Type the cash counted in the drawer using the **number keypad**, then tap **"OPEN"**. The badge at the top changes to **"Shift Open"**.

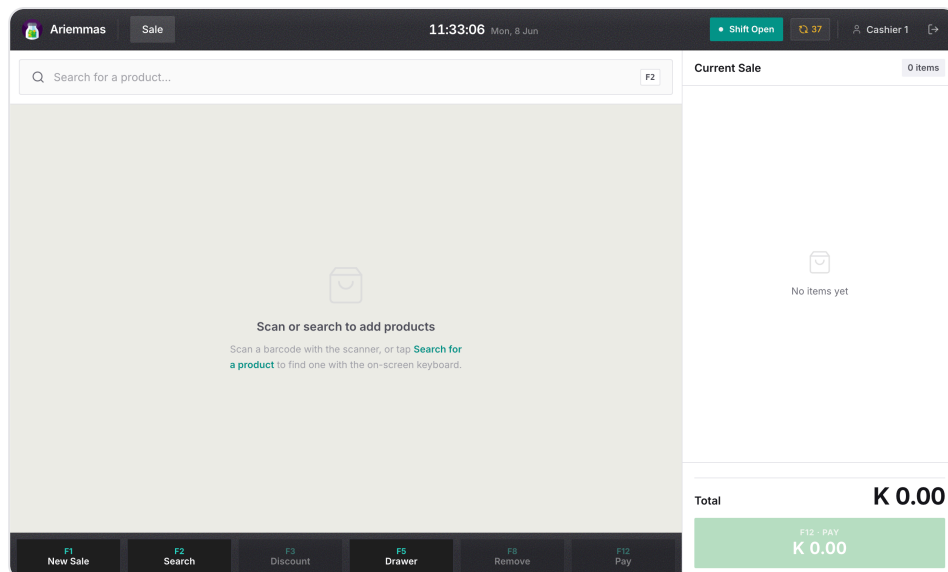
No Windows keyboard needed

The till is a touch screen. Letters come from the on-screen keyboard that appears when you tap the name box; numbers come from the keypad. You never need the Windows keyboard.

Why the name matters

Five cashiers share three terminals and swap during the day. The name you type here is how the owner's report tells *who* actually rang each sale. Always type your own name.

2.3 The sale screen



The sale screen. Search bar across the top, the items you add fill the large area in the middle, and the **Current Sale** panel on the right keeps the running total.

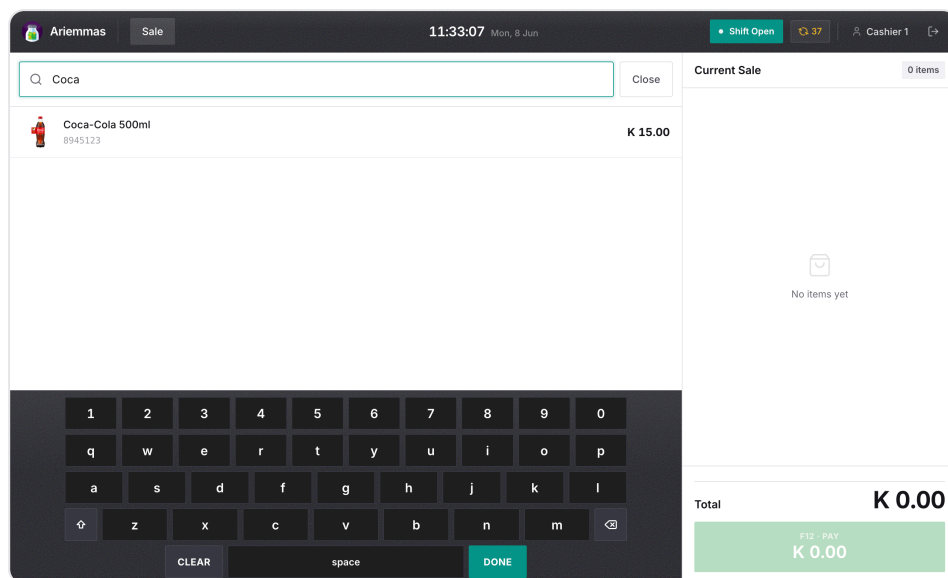
- **Search bar (top):** tap it to bring up the on-screen keyboard, or scan a barcode.
- **Main area (middle):** every item you scan or add appears here, with its price and quantity. Use **– / +** to change quantity and **X** to remove a line.
- **Current Sale (right):** a tidy summary of the same items, the **Total**, and the green **Pay** button.
- **Function bar (bottom):** the grey buttons — **F1** New Sale, **F2** Search, **F5** Drawer, **F8** Remove, **F12** Pay.

2.4 Adding products to the sale

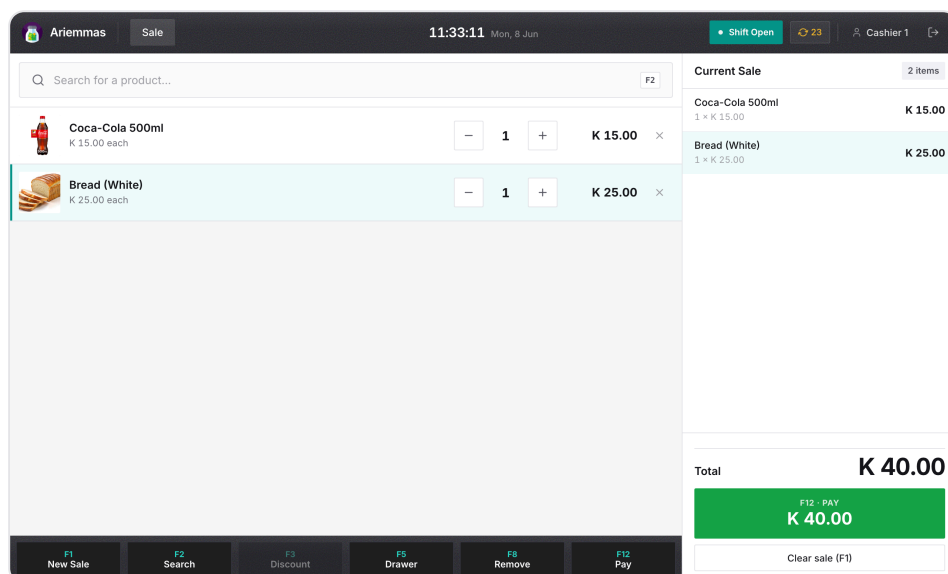
There are two ways to add an item — whichever is faster for you. Either way, the item shows up **both** in the large main area and in the Current Sale summary on the right.

A. Scan the barcode. Point the barcode scanner at the product. It's added instantly.

B. Search by name. Tap **"Search for a product"** (or press **F2**). An on-screen keyboard appears — type a few letters and the matching products list below. Tap the one you want to add it.



The search keyboard. Type with the on-screen keys; matches show with price and stock. Tap a product to add it, then tap **Close** when you're done searching.



Items added to the sale. Change quantity with **– / +** in the main area, or remove a line with **X**. The Current Sale total on the right updates automatically.

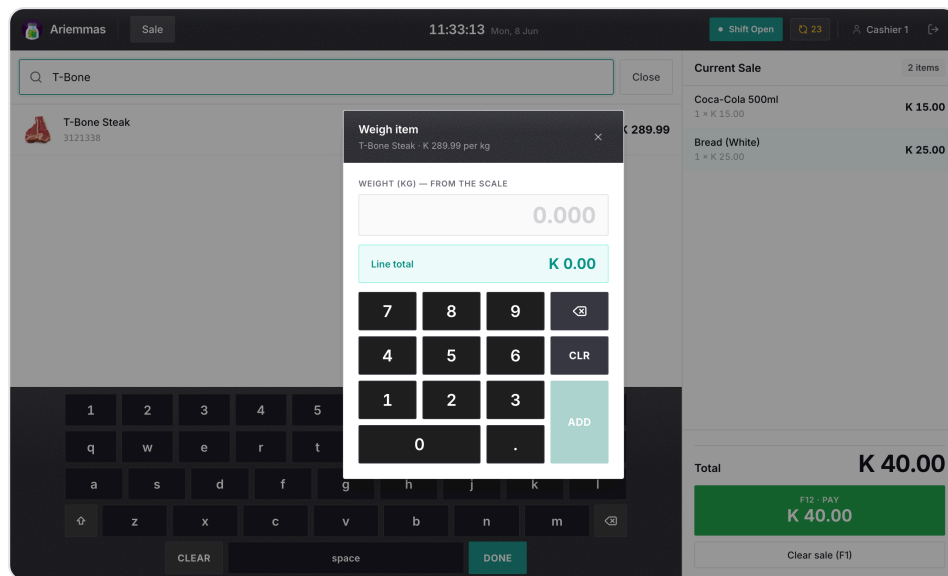
Handy keys

F2 jump to search · **F8** remove the selected line · **F1** clear the whole sale · **F12** take payment.

2.5 Selling by weight — the butchery

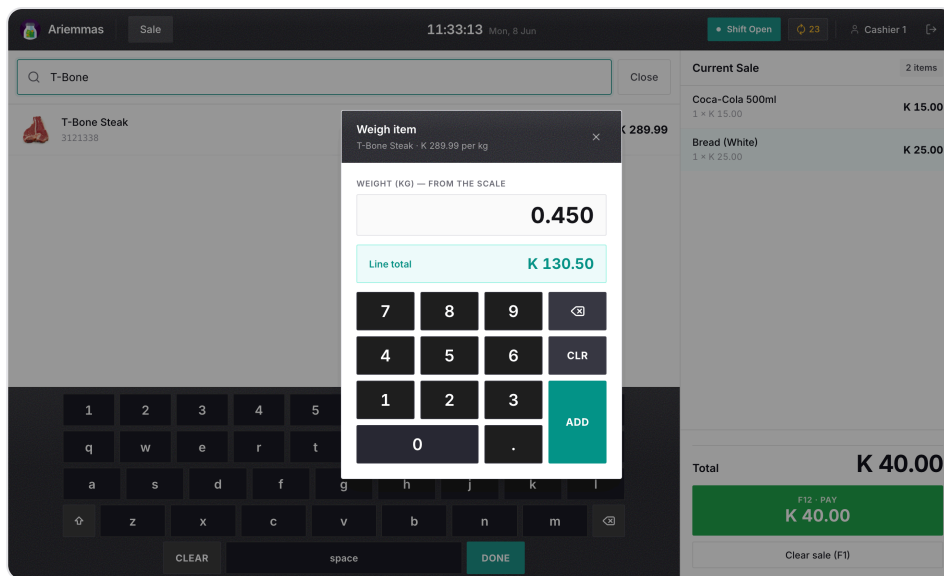
Meat and other items sold by weight work a little differently. The price you see is the **price per kilogram**, and you tell the till how much the item weighs.

- 1 **Weigh the item on the shop scale.** The scale shows the weight, for example **0.450 kg**. (The scale is separate — the till does not read it automatically.)
- 2 Scan or search the item as normal — for example *T-Bone Steak*.
- 3 Because it's a weighed item, a **"Weigh item"** window pops up.

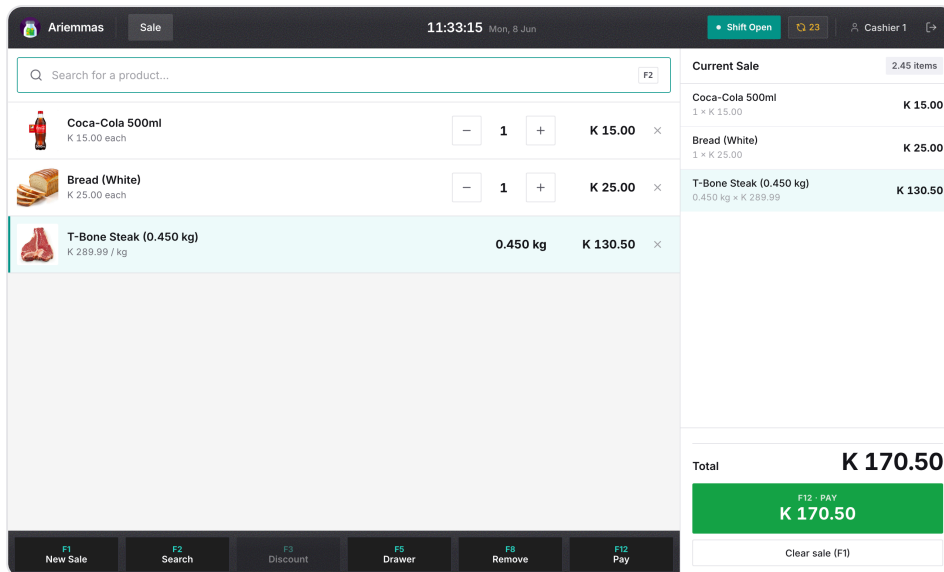


The Weigh item window. It shows the item name and the price per kg at the top.

- 1 Type the weight from the scale into **"Weight (kg)"** — for example **0.450**. Use a dot for the decimal.
- 2 The **Line total** updates as you type, so you can check it before adding.
- 3 Tap **"Add to cart"** (or press Enter).



0.450 kg of T-Bone at K 289.99/kg = **K 130.50**, shown live before you add it.



The weighed item in the cart. It reads **"T-Bone Steak (0.450 kg)"** so it's clear how much was sold.

Careful: kilograms, not grams

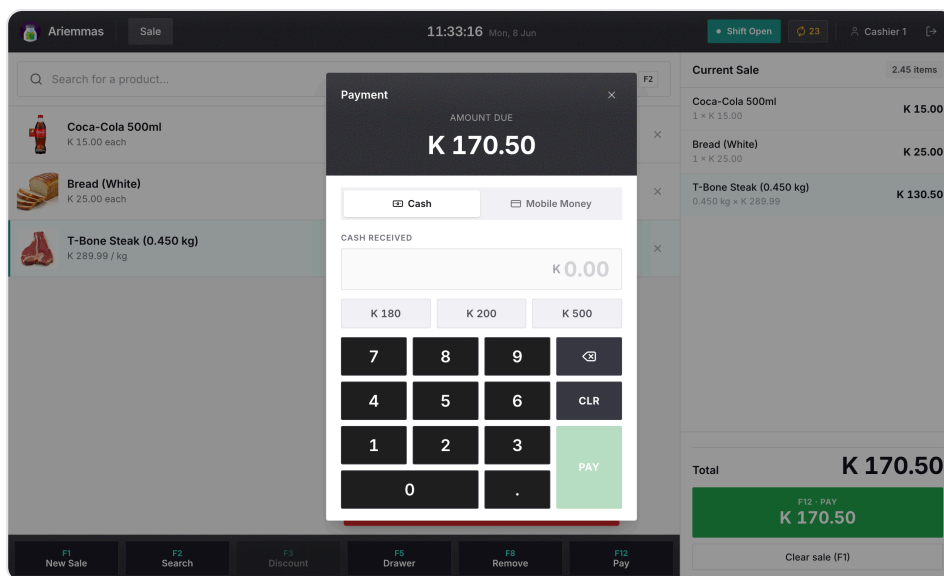
The scale shows kilograms. If it reads **0.450**, type **0.450** — not **450**. Typing **450** would charge the customer for 450 kilograms. If the line total looks far too big, you typed grams by mistake — tap **X** and re-do it.

Each weighing is its own line

If a customer buys two separate cuts of the same meat, weigh and add them one at a time. Each becomes its own line, so you can sell different weights of the same product in one sale.

2.6 Taking payment

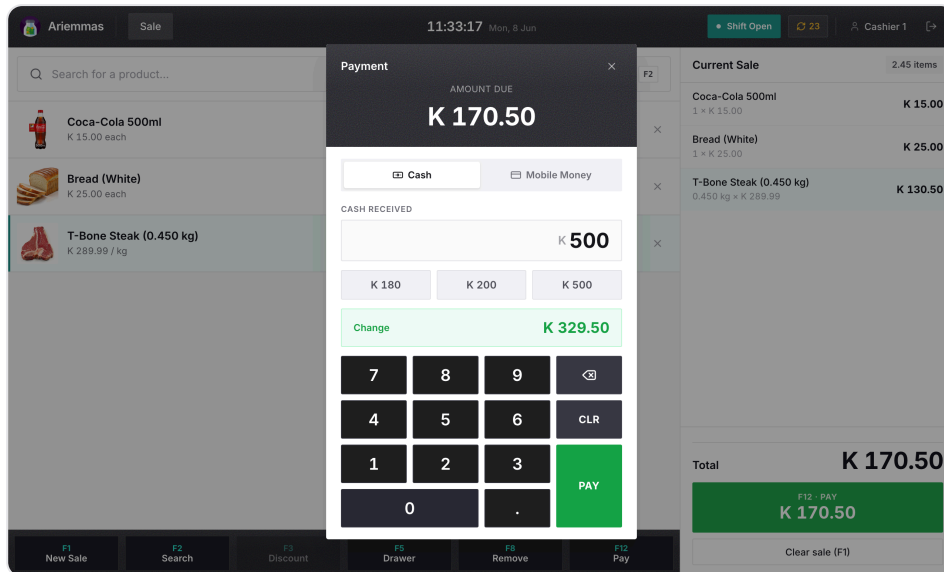
When the cart is complete, tap the green **"Pay"** button (or press **F12**).



The payment window. Choose **Cash** or **Mobile Money**. The amount due is shown big at the top.

For a cash payment:

- 1 Type the cash the customer handed you into **"Cash Received"**, or tap one of the quick amounts (**K 50**, **K 100**, **K 500...**).
- 2 The **Change** to give back is worked out for you.
- 3 Tap **"Pay"** to finish.



Customer paid **K 500** on a **K 170.50** sale → the till shows **K 329.50** change.

For mobile money: tap **Mobile Money**, enter the reference number from the customer's payment confirmation, and tap **Pay**.

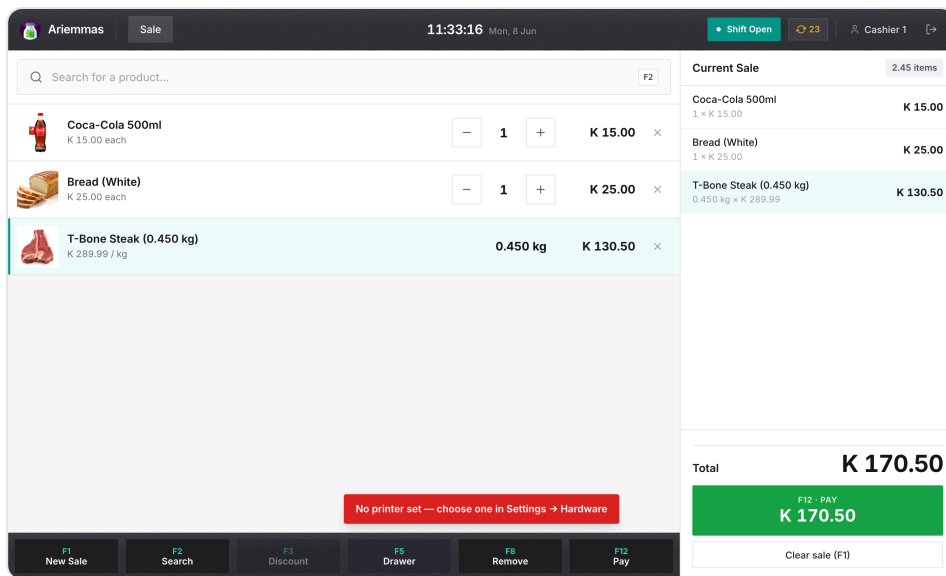
2.7 Receipt & cash drawer

As soon as the sale is finished:

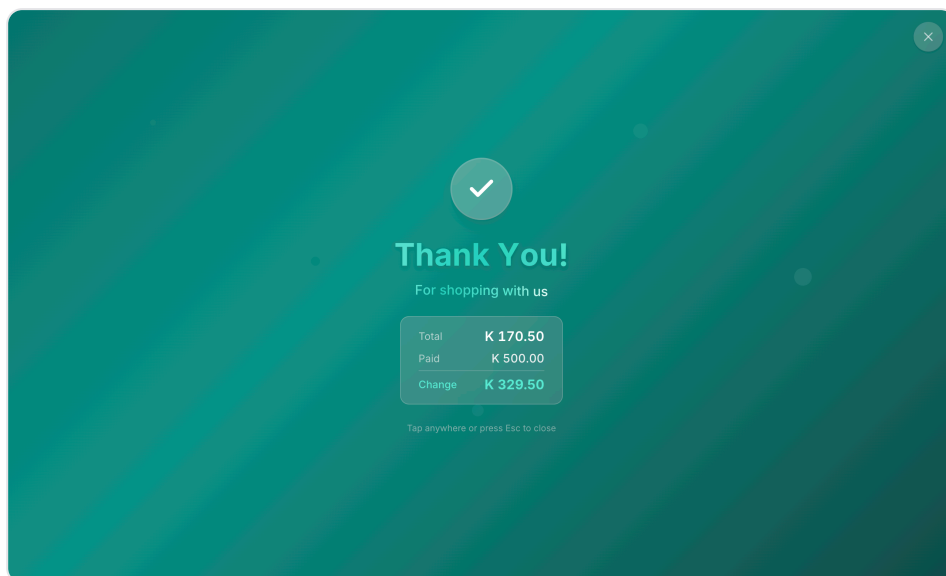
- The **receipt prints** automatically — hand it to the customer. It shows the cashier, the date and time in **Mongu time**, and the items.
- On a **cash** sale, the **cash drawer opens** automatically so you can put the money in and take out change.
- A **"Thank You"** screen confirms the sale, showing the total, amount paid, and change.

Opening the drawer on its own

Need the drawer without a sale (for example to give change)? Tap **F5 Drawer** on the bottom bar. A small message confirms *"Cash drawer opened"*. If it says *"No printer set"*, the drawer can't open until a printer is chosen in **Settings → Hardware** (the drawer is wired to the printer).



The bottom function bar. Tapping **F5** Drawer shows a “Cash drawer opened” confirmation. The same bar has New Sale, Search, Remove and Pay.



Sale complete. The screen confirms total, paid, and change, then returns to a fresh sale.

2.8 Closing your shift

At the end of your time on the till, close your shift so the day's cash can be checked.

- 1 Tap the **"Shift Open"** badge at the top right.
- 2 Count the cash in the drawer and type it into **"Closing Cash"**.
- 3 Add a note if anything unusual happened (optional).
- 4 Tap **"Close Shift"**. The system compares your count to what it expected and records any difference.

Swapping cashiers on one terminal

When you hand the till to the next person: **close your shift**, then **sign out** (the arrow icon, top right). The next cashier signs in with their own login and opens their own shift.

2.9 The rules — read this once

RULE	WHY
Sign in as yourself	Every sale is tagged to your login for the owner's report.
Type your real name at shift open	So the report shows the person, not just "Cashier 1".
One cashier login, one terminal at a time	If you're already signed in on another till, the system will stop a second sign-in with the same login.
Check the weight before adding meat	Kilograms, not grams. A wrong weight overcharges the customer.
Close your shift before handing over	So the drawer balances against your sales.

Administrator Guide

There are **two admin logins** (the owner and the supervisor). Both PINs — and every cashier login — are listed in the credentials file **ariemmas-credentials.txt**, saved to the Downloads folder when the app is first installed. Admins see extra tabs: **Products**, **Reports**, and **Settings**.

3.1 Managing products

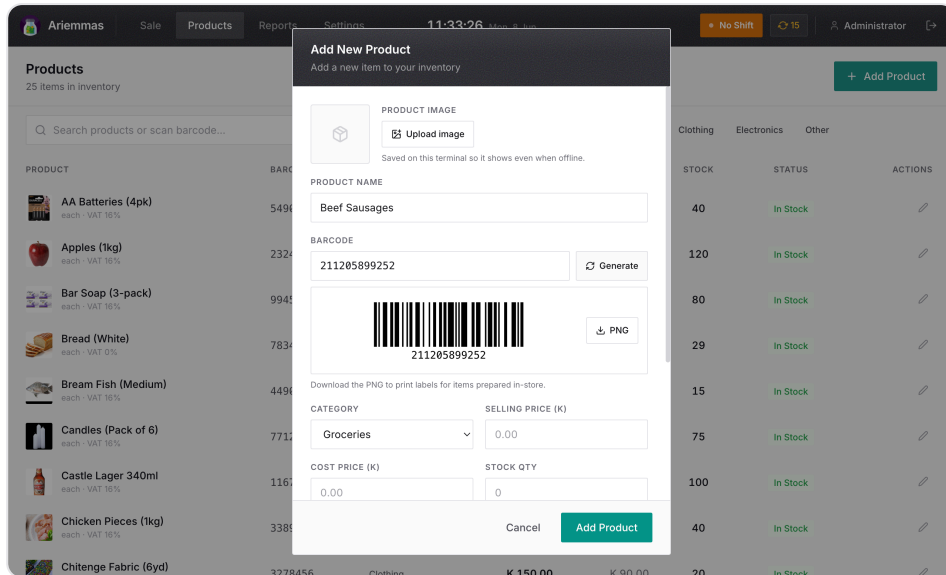
PRODUCT	BARCODE	CATEGORY	PRICE	COST	STOCK	STATUS	ACTIONS
AA Batteries (4pk) each - VAT 16%	5490678	Electronics	K 35.00	K 18.00	40	In Stock	
Apples (1kg) each - VAT 16%	2324345	Groceries	K 55.89	K 40.00	120	In Stock	
Bar Soap (3-pack) each - VAT 16%	9945123	Household	K 35.00	K 22.00	80	In Stock	
Bread (White) each - VAT 0%	7834562	Groceries	K 25.00	K 18.00	29	In Stock	
Bream Fish (Medium) each - VAT 16%	4490678	Meat & Fish	K 120.00	K 80.00	15	In Stock	
Candles (Pack of 6) each - VAT 16%	7712890	Household	K 18.00	K 10.00	75	In Stock	
Castle Lager 340ml each - VAT 16%	1167345	Beverages	K 22.00	K 15.00	100	In Stock	
Chicken Pieces (1kg) each - VAT 16%	3389567	Meat & Fish	K 85.00	K 60.00	40	In Stock	
Chitenge Fabric (6yd)	3278456	Clothing	K 150.00	K 90.00	20	In Stock	

The Products screen. Every item with its barcode, price, stock and status. Tap **"Add Product"** to create one, or the pencil to edit.

- 1 Go to the **Products** tab.
- 2 Tap **"Add Product"** (top right) to add a new item, or the **pencil** icon to edit an existing one.
- 3 Fill in the name, price, category, stock and VAT rate, then tap **"Add Product"** / **"Update Product"**.

3.2 Generating & printing barcodes

For items you prepare in-store (like home-made food) that have no barcode, the system can **make one for you** and you can print it as a label.



Add/Edit Product. Tap **“Generate”** to create a barcode, see it previewed, then tap **“PNG”** to download a printable label.

- 1 In the product window, tap **“Generate”** next to the barcode field — a unique barcode is created.
- 2 The barcode preview appears below.
- 3 Tap **“PNG”** to download the barcode image, then print it and stick it on the product.

Works offline

The barcode generator needs no internet — it works on the terminal at any time.

3.3 Setting up a butchery (weighed) item

Add New Product
Add a new item to your inventory

Download the PNG to print labels for items prepared in-store.

CATEGORY: Groceries | SELLING PRICE (K): 0.00

COST PRICE (K): 0.00 | STOCK QTY: 0

MIN STOCK ALERT: 5 | VAT RATE: Standard (16%)

UNIT: Kilogram

☒ **Sold by weight (butchery)**
Cashier weighs the item and types the weight in kg; the price above is price per kg.

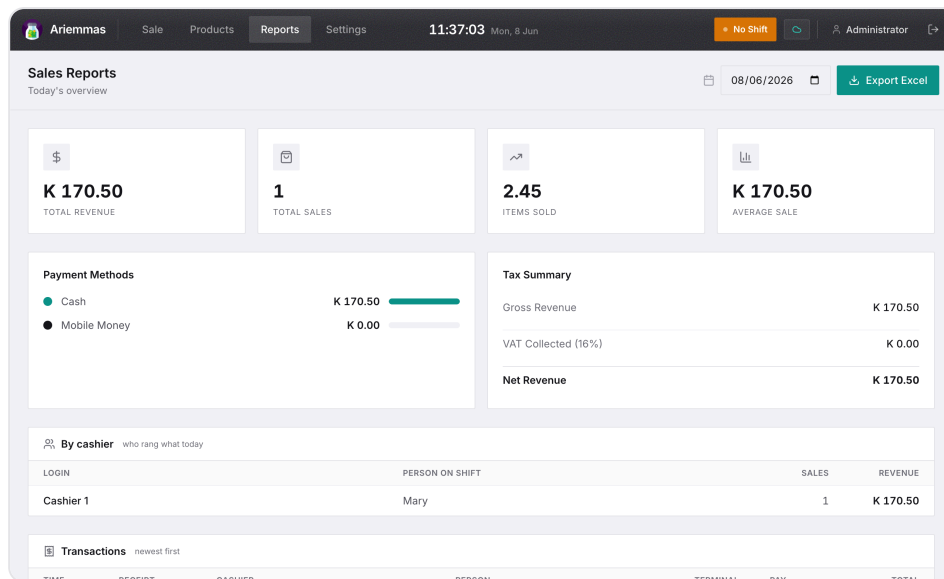
Cancel | Add Product

Tick **"Sold by weight (butchery)"**. The unit switches to **kg** and the price becomes **price per kg**.

- 1 Add or edit the product (for example, *T-Bone Steak*).
- 2 Set the **Selling Price** to the **price per kilogram**.
- 3 Tick **"Sold by weight (butchery)"** near the bottom.
- 4 Save. Now, whenever a cashier adds this item, the **Weigh item** window appears automatically (see section 2.5).

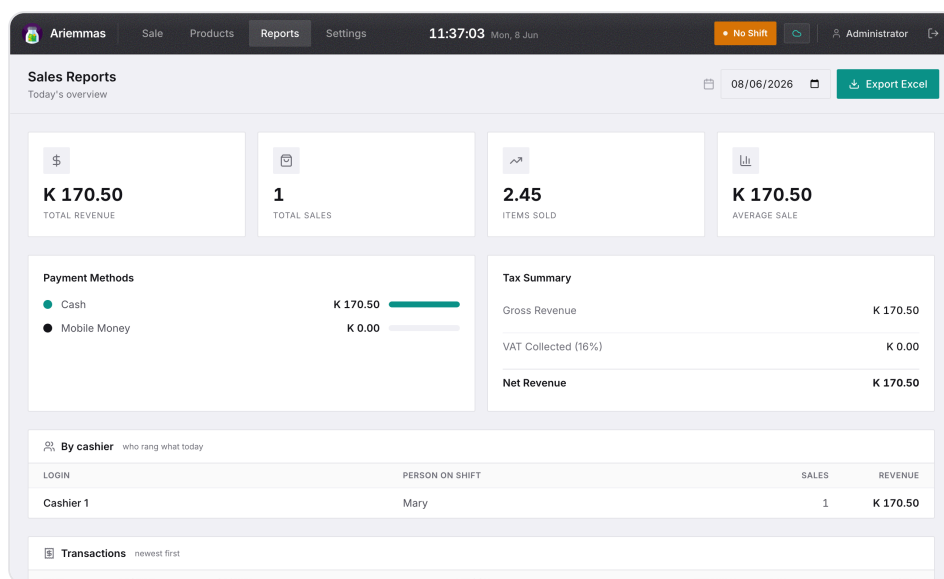
3.4 Reports — who sold what

The **Reports** tab is where the owner sees the day's trading. Pick a date at the top right; everything updates for that day.

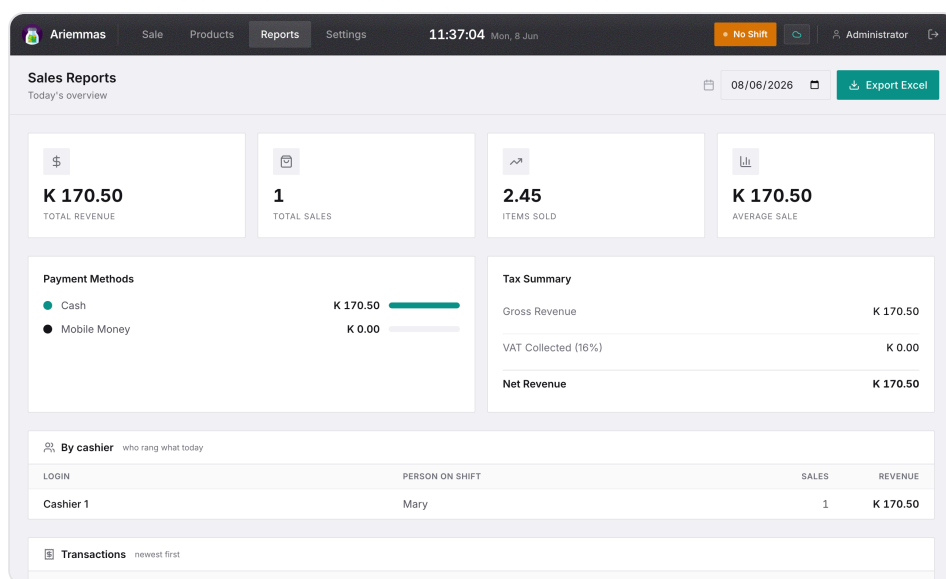


Daily overview. Total revenue, number of sales, items sold, average sale, the cash/mobile split, and the VAT summary.

Scroll down for the part that matters most for staff accountability — **By cashier** and the full **Transactions** list.



By cashier. Each login, the **real person on shift**, how many sales they made and their total — for example Joyce Mwanza: 3 sales, K 245.00.



Every transaction. Time, receipt number, cashier login, the person on shift, terminal, payment method and total — newest first.

This is exactly how the owner answers “who served this customer and on which till?” — the cashier login and the typed name are recorded on every single sale, even across the different terminals.

3.5 Exporting to Excel

- 1 Pick the date you want.
- 2 Tap “**Export Excel**” (top right of Reports).
- 3 A spreadsheet is saved with two sheets: a **Sales Summary** (every receipt with cashier, person on shift, terminal, payment and totals) and a **Line Items** sheet (every product sold).

Good for record-keeping

Export at the end of each day or week and keep the files as the shop’s sales record and for ZRA bookkeeping.

3.6 Settings & hardware

The **Settings** tab holds the shop details on the receipt, cash-drawer alerts, and the hardware controls.

The screenshot shows the Ariemmas POS interface with the 'Settings' tab selected. The top navigation bar includes 'Sale', 'Products', 'Reports', and 'Settings'. The 'Settings' section is titled 'Manage your POS configuration' and has a 'Save Changes' button. It is divided into two main sections: 'Shop Information' and 'Receipt Settings'. 'Shop Information' includes fields for 'SHOP NAME' (Ariemmas), 'ADDRESS' (Independence Ave Mongu), 'PHONE' (097 4542233), and 'TPIN' (ZRA Tax Payer ID). 'Receipt Settings' includes fields for 'RECEIPT HEADER MESSAGE' (Welcome to Ariemmas!) and 'RECEIPT FOOTER MESSAGE' (Thank you for shopping at Ariemmas!).

Settings. Shop name, address and details printed on receipts, plus cash-alert options.

3.6.1 Turning VAT on or off

VAT ships **switched off**, which is correct while the business is not yet VAT-registered. With VAT off there is no VAT line on receipts — customers just see the Total.

This screenshot shows the 'Receipt Settings' section of the Ariemmas POS interface. It includes fields for 'RECEIPT HEADER MESSAGE' (Welcome to Ariemmas!) and 'RECEIPT FOOTER MESSAGE' (Thank you for shopping at Ariemmas!). Below these is the 'Charge VAT' section, which has a toggle switch (currently off) and a 'VAT RATE (%)' field set to 0.16. The 'Cash Drawer Alerts' section is also visible, with fields for 'OPENING CASH LIMIT (K)' (1000) and 'CASH ALERT THRESHOLD (K)' (2000).

The “Charge VAT” switch. In Settings → Receipt Settings. Off (grey) = no VAT. On (teal) = VAT is calculated at the rate below and shown on receipts.

- 1 Leave **“Charge VAT” off** until the business is registered for VAT with ZRA.
- 2 When you register, switch it **on**, check the **VAT Rate** (16% in Zambia), and tap **Save**.

- 3 From then on every receipt shows the VAT portion automatically. Shelf prices don't change — they're treated as VAT-inclusive.

3.6.2 Printer & drawer

The screenshot shows the Ariemmas POS Settings interface. At the top, there's a navigation bar with 'Sale', 'Products', 'Reports', and 'Settings' (selected). The time is 11:37:07 on Mon, 8 Jun. A 'No Shift' button and a user profile 'Administrator' are on the right. The main section is titled 'Settings' with the subtitle 'Manage your POS configuration'. It includes a 'Save Changes' button. Below this, there are two input fields: 'OPENING CASH LIMIT (K)' with the value '1000' and 'CASH ALERT THRESHOLD (K)' with the value '2000'. An 'ALERT EMAIL RECIPIENT' field contains 'owner@example.com'. A note states: 'The app sends an alert when opening cash plus cash sales reaches the threshold above.' The 'Hardware' section, titled 'Connected peripherals status', contains three items: 1. 'Receipt Printer' with a printer icon, 'No printer found', and a 'Not Connected' status. 2. 'ACTIVE PRINTER' with a dropdown menu showing 'System default printer', a note 'No printers found in Windows. Install the printer driver first, then click Refresh.', and buttons for 'Refresh', 'Test Print', and 'Open Drawer'. 3. 'Barcode Scanner' with a scanner icon, 'USB HID Keyboard Mode', and a green 'Auto-detect' status.

Hardware section. Choose the receipt printer, then use **Test Print** and **Open Drawer** to confirm the hardware works.

- 1 Under **Hardware → Active Printer**, pick your receipt printer from the list.
- 2 Tap **“Test Print”** — a test slip should print.
- 3 Tap **“Open Drawer”** — the cash drawer should pop open.

Hardware: printer & cash drawer

This is a one-time setup, usually done by the administrator when a terminal is installed.

4.1 How the pieces connect

The important thing to understand: **the cash drawer is opened by the printer, not the terminal**. The drawer's cable plugs into the *printer*, and the printer sends the pulse that pops it open when a receipt prints.

CABLE	PLUGS INTO
Printer power	Wall socket → round power port on the printer
Printer → PC (USB)	The square USB-B port on the printer → the terminal
Cash drawer cable	The white "DK / Cash Drawer" port on the printer — <i>not</i> the LAN port, <i>not</i> the touchscreen

The drawer cable looks like a network cable but isn't

It's a telephone-style (RJ11/RJ12) plug — slightly narrower than a network (LAN) cable. It must go into the printer's white drawer port. Plugged into the terminal or the LAN port, the drawer will never open.

4.2 First-time setup checklist

- 1 Plug the **drawer cable into the printer's white DK port**.
- 2 Connect the printer to the terminal by **USB** and switch it on.
- 3 On Windows, make sure the printer appears under **Printers & scanners** and prints a Windows test page. (Install the printer's driver if it doesn't show up.)
- 4 In the app, go to **Settings → Hardware**, choose the printer, and run **Test Print** and **Open Drawer**.

Once it's set up

Every cash sale prints the receipt and opens the drawer automatically — cashiers don't need to do anything extra.

Troubleshooting & FAQ

PROBLEM	WHAT TO DO
"Invalid username or PIN"	Re-type your username and PIN carefully (your supervisor has them). After 3 wrong tries the login locks for 5 minutes. If it still fails, ask the admin to confirm your login is active.
It won't let me sign in — says I'm already signed in elsewhere	Your login is open on another terminal. Close the shift and sign out there first, or wait a few minutes for it to release.
The cash drawer didn't open	Check the drawer cable is in the printer's white DK port . The drawer only opens on cash sales and only when the receipt prints.
The receipt didn't print	Check the printer is on, has paper, and is selected in Settings → Hardware . Run Test Print .
A meat sale total looks far too high	You likely typed grams instead of kilograms. Remove the line (X) and re-add it — type kilograms, e.g. 0.450 .
The "Pay" button is greyed out	Either the cart is empty or no shift is open. Add an item and make sure the badge says "Shift Open" .
I can't see Products / Reports / Settings	Those are admin-only. Sign in with the admin login.
The internet is down	Keep selling — the till works offline and syncs automatically when the connection returns.

Frequently asked

Do I need internet to sell? No. The till works fully offline and catches up later.

Can two cashiers use the same login? No — one login works on one terminal at a time, on purpose, so sales are tracked to the right person.

What if I make a mistake on a line? Tap the X on that line to remove it, or **F1** to clear the whole sale and start again.

Why is there no VAT on the receipt? VAT is switched off until the business is registered for VAT. The owner can turn it on any time in **Settings → Charge VAT**. Cashiers don't need to do anything differently.

Quick reference card

Print this page and pin it next to each till.

Keyboard shortcuts

F1	Clear / new sale
F2	Jump to search
F5	Open cash drawer
F8	Remove selected line
F12	Take payment

Everyday checklist

- ☐ Sign in as yourself
- ☐ Open shift — type your name
- ☐ Enter opening cash
- ☐ Sell all day
- ☐ Close shift & count drawer
- ☐ Sign out when handing over

Selling by weight, in three steps

- 1 Weigh on the scale (e.g. **0.450 kg**).
- 2 Scan/search the item → the **Weigh item** window opens.
- 3 Type the kilograms (0.450), check the total, **Add to cart**.

Golden rules

- Always sign in as **yourself** and type your **real name** at shift open.
- Weighed items are in **kilograms** — never grams.
- **Close your shift** before you hand the till to the next person.

Need help?

Show this guide to the administrator, or contact the system supplier. Keep the admin credentials file (saved in the Downloads folder) somewhere safe and private.